מילים באבן – renderings, conventions, gates

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Binding for every text of the corpus (guidelines §6.6). The nearest model is the Ugaritic corpus (`../מיתוסים-אוגריתיים/renderings.md`): a cousin language, where the cognate is chosen whenever the meaning matches,
and the danger is understanding too much.

1. Transcription and transliteration

- **Square script, diplomatic:** no final letter forms (the scripts have none); `·` = the original's word divider
  (dot or short stroke); `|` = the Mesha stele's vertical stroke; `[ ]` = restored (the base edition's restorations);
  `[...]` / `[..]` = lost letters; a letter followed by U+05C4 ̇ = an uncertain letter (Compston's overline; Wikipedia's
  "h/w"); `{n}` = a numeral sign (Punic), written in digits.
- **Latin:** generated by `stone_tools.py translit` (ʾ b g d h w z ḥ ṭ y k l m n s ʿ p ṣ q r š t; an uncertain letter
  with a ring above, `å`). Never typed by hand.

2. The vocalized reading (Hebrew, Moabite)

- The consonants are the inscription's, in order; the vowels are a **proposal** written with Tiberian signs as notation.
  Final letter forms, maqaf, spaces and punctuation are ours. A word broken across a line ends / begins with `-`.

- **Moabite forms vocalized as Moabite:** plural -īn (אֱלָפִין, שְׁלֹשִׁין, מְלָכִין); 3ms suffix -ō(h) written ה
  (לֹה, בְּנֹה, אַרְצֹה); אָנֹךְ "I" (ʾnk – Moabite writes final long vowels, so no -ī); שָׁת "year"; בָּנְתִי "I built" (no medial yod); the Gt קָר; אֶלְתַּחֵם "town"; אֵן "there is not"; הֶא "he".
- **Judahite / Israelite forms:** the 3ms suffix -ō written (עַבְדֹּה, אֲשֵׁרְתֹּה) ה; the 2ms suffix written -k
  (עַבְדְּךָ, אֵלֶיךָ); a doubled kk written once (יְבָרֶךָּ – non-final כ with qamats, so that the letters match);
  the northern -yaw names (אֲמַרְיָו) beside the Judahite -yāhū (הוֹשַׁעְיָהוּ).
- **The Name** יהוה is never vocalized (in Mesha, ʿAjrud, Ketef Hinnom), nor is a broken יה־ / ־וה.
- **Uncertain words stay unvocalized** (Mesha 31 שדק 34, דה 33, בת וק אש), and the apparatus gives the readings.
- **Glosses** only in **פירוק**, for words a modern reader would misread: Moabite קר "town" (not "cold"), רית,
  אשוח "reservoir", רחמת "young women" (not "wombs"), גרנ "boys" (not "threshing floors"), שת "year",
  משמעת "subject"; Hebrew ענה ל־ "testify", נקי מ־ "free of", ואמלא = "and if not".

3. Names (first occurrence vocalized)

Original	Hebrew	Note
mšʿ	מֵשַׁע (reading)	the Bible's מֵישַׁע (2 Kgs 3:4) in the apparatus
kmš	כְּמֹשׁ	
ʿštr kmš	עַשְׁתַּר כְּמֹשׁ	a male Ashtar, never עַשְׁתֹּרֶת
ʿmry	עָמְרִי	
dybn, mhdbʾ, ʿṭrt, nbh, yhṣ, ḥwrnn, bʿlmʿn, qrytn, ʿrʿr, bṣr, bt bmt, bt dbltn	דִּיבֹן, מְהֵדְבָא, עֲטָרֹת, נְבֹה, יַהַץ, חוֹרֹנִן, בַּעַלְמְעֹן, קִרְיָתֵן, עֲרֹעֵר, בָּצֶר, בֵּת בָּמֹת, בֵּת דִּבְלָתֵן	Moabite spellings kept in the reading; the biblical forms in the apparatus
qrḥh	קַרְחֹה	Dibon's citadel (?)
šmrn, tmn	שֹׁמְרֹן, תֵּמָן	"YHWH of Samaria / of Teman"
ḥlṣbʿl, bdtnt, bdʾšmn	חִלֶּצְבַּעַל, בּוֹדְתִּנִּית, בּוֹדְאֶשְׁמוּן	the Carthaginian suffetes (MT)

The echo tag on a proper name (the lead's rule, 2026-11-02; guidelines §6.4): in a הקבלה tag on a place, a people, a
person or a god, `[cognate]` when the name is the same word as the Bible's (Mesha / מֵישַׁע, Dibon, Medeba, Gad, Kemosh,
Ataroth, Nebo, Baal-meon, Kiriathaim, Jahaz, Arnon, Hoshaiah …: the same name, even as a loan or a transcription);
`[equivalent]` only when the Bible names the same thing by another word (Deut 33:2's Sinai / Seir / Paran for ʿAjrud's
Teman). **2026-11-02 harmonization** (the Round 5 finalization): applied to every tag of the corpus – changed from
[equivalent] to [cognate]: MS 1 (Mesha, 2 Kgs 3:4), MS 2 (Dibon, Num 32:34), MS 8 (Medeba, Josh 13:9), MS 9 (Baal-meon,
Num 32:38), MS 10 (Kiriathaim, Jer 48:1), MS 19 (Jahaz, Num 21:23), MH 7 (Hoshaiah, Neh 12:32); no `>` line changed.

4. Punic translation: renderings and gates (mode `translation`; `RESERVED_PUN`, `TRAPS_PUN` in the tool)

Cognates kept (the meaning matches), each reserved for its Punic word: kll כָּלִיל [cognate]; šlm שָׁלָם
(שָׁלָם כָּלִיל); khn כֹּהֵן; zbḥ זָבַח / זֶבַח, bʿl hzbḥ בַּעַל הַזֶּבַח; mnḥt מִנְחָה; ʿrt עוֹר;
ṣpr צִפּוֹר; dl דַּל; mqnʾ מִקְנָה; qdš קֹדֶשׁ; šʾr שְׁאֵר "flesh" (always vocalized); mšʾt
מַשְׁאֵת "payment" (2 Chr 24:6); ʾgrt אֲגוֹרָה (1 Sam 2:36); špṭ שׁוֹפֵט; bll בְּלִיל; mrzḥ מַרְזֵחַ;
pʿmm פְּעָמִים "feet" (always vocalized); ʿgl עֶגֶל; ybl יוֹבֵל "ram" (Josh 6:4; vocalized); ʾyl אַיָּל
(Cooke's "hart"; vocalized); ʾmr אֶמֶר "lamb" (Ezra 6:9; vocalized); gdʾ גְּדִי; ʿz עֵז; ḥlb חֶלֶב /
חֵלֶב (both always vocalized); šmn שֶׁמֶן; špḥ מִשְׁפָּחָה; nʿnš נָעֲנַשׁ; ḥbr חָבֵר.
By sense: ʾlp בָּקָר (as Ugaritic *alp*; Hebrew אֶלֶף is "thousand"); ʿlt pn נוֹסָף עַל (never עוֹלָה);
ykn / kn וְהָיָה / יִהְיֶה; ʾš (rel.) אֲשֶׁר; ʾšm (pl. of ʾš) הָאֲנָשִׁים (never אֲשֶׁם); ʾdmm
אָדָם; ps לוּחַ; ktbt כְּתוּבוֹת; ʾybl / bl בַּל / לֹא; mnm מְאוּמָה; ʿt r בְּעֵת הָרַב; ʾlm
הָאֵלִים (as Ugaritic *ilm*; Phoenician may mean a singular "god": noted).
Transliterated (meaning unknown), italic and vocalized: ṣwʿt **צִוְעַת**, qṣrt **קְצָרוֹת**, yṣlt
יְצֵלוֹת, šlbm **שְׁלַבִּים**, ʾgnn **אַגְנָן**, ṣṣ **צִיץ**, šṣp **שַׁצָּף**, ḥzt **חֲזָת**, zr
זָר (a coin; vocalized), mzrḥ מִזְרַח (a guild; vocalized), qdmt **קַדְמַת**.
Never in a line (Leviticus words the tariff does not have; the absences are findings): עוֹלָה,
חַטָּאת,
נִיחוֹחַ, אִשֶּׁה, קָרְבָּן, שׁוֹק, חָזֶה, תְּרוּמָה, תְּנוּפָה, אָשָׁם, the root רֵאשִׁית, בִּכּוּרִים, כפר,
מִלֶּא.
Fixed formula (MT 4, 6, 8, 10): וְהָיוּ הָעוֹר וְהַשְּׁלַבִּים וְהַפְּעָמִים וְיֶתֶר הַשְּׁאֵר לְבַעַל הַזֶּבַח.

5. For the Aramaic texts still to come (Fekheriye, Sefire)

Fix before their first line: *ṣlm* צָלֶם and *dmwt* דְּמוּת [cognate; Gen 1:26, 5:3] reserved for them (and
דְּמוּת never for any other word); *ʿdy* עֲדֵי (with the debated עֵדוּת and the Akkadian *adê* אֲמָנָה of the law corpus in the apparatus – a split for the lead); the futility-curse formula; *gwgl* "canal-inspector"; the gods'
names transcribed (הַדַּד as in the Ugaritic corpus).

6. Traps (always vocalized, or avoided)

מזרח (guild / east), שאר (flesh / rest), חלב (milk / fat), אמר (lamb / said), פעמים ,אייל / איל (feet / times), יובל (ram / jubilee), זר (coin / stranger) – checked by the tool in translation lines. In readings:
קָר / קר "town" (not "cold"), הָא = הא (not the interjection), יָמֶיהָ = ימה "his days" (not "seaward").